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THE SHADOW GAME
Connecting the Dots from the Old Testament to Jesus
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A Note for Parents

Have you ever played a game of connect the dots? You start with a bunch of dots on a page. They look like random dots. They look like nothing. But then you draw a line from one dot to the next. And then to the next. And slowly, a picture appears. It was there all along. You just had to connect the dots.

The Old Testament is like a connect the dots page. There are stories. There are people. There are rules. There are ceremonies. They can seem random. They can seem disconnected. They can seem like they do not have anything to do with Jesus. But they do. Every dot connects. Every story connects. Every person connects. They all point to Jesus. They all draw a picture of Him. The picture was there all along. We just have to connect the dots.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to play the shadow game. We are going to look at 30 Old Testament dots. We are going to connect them to Jesus. We are going to see the picture. Get ready to draw. Get ready to connect. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the shadow. Read the connection. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Shadow of the Firstborn

The Shadow
"Consecrate to me every firstborn male. The first offspring of every womb among the Israelites belongs to me, whether human or animal." - Exodus 13:2

In the Old Testament, the firstborn was special. The firstborn got the double portion. The firstborn got the blessing. The firstborn got the authority. But God said the firstborn belonged to Him. Why? Because God saved the firstborn of Israel during the Passover. The firstborn was a reminder. It was a dot. It was a shadow.

The Connection
"For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters." - Romans 8:29

Connect the dot. The firstborn points to Jesus. Jesus is the firstborn. He is the firstborn of all creation. He is the firstborn from the dead. He is the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a list of the firstborns in your family. Talk about how the firstborn was special in the Old Testament. Talk about how Jesus is the firstborn. He is the special one. He is the one who saves us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the firstborn. Thank you for making me part of the family. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A family with a big heart in the middle.

Day 02: The Shadow of the Lamb

The Shadow
"Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male a year old. You may take it from the sheep or from the goats." - Exodus 12:5

In the Old Testament, the lamb was special. It had to be perfect. It had to be without spot. It had to be without blemish. It had to be killed. It had to be eaten. The lamb was a dot. The lamb was a shadow.

The Connection
"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

Connect the dot. The lamb points to Jesus. Jesus is the Lamb of God. He is perfect. He is without spot. He is without blemish. He was killed. He was sacrificed. He takes away the sin of the world. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Add a big heart on the lamb. Talk about how the lamb had to be perfect. Talk about how Jesus is the perfect Lamb. He gave His life for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the perfect Lamb. Thank you for taking away my sin. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile.

Day 03: The Shadow of the Blood

The Shadow
"The blood will be a sign for you on the houses where you are, and when I see the blood, I will pass over you." - Exodus 12:13

In the Old Testament, the blood was special. It was a sign. It was a protection. It was a covering. The blood was painted on the doorposts. The blood saved the people. The blood was a dot. The blood was a shadow.

The Connection
"For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed." - 1 Corinthians 5:7

Connect the dot. The blood points to Jesus. Jesus is our Passover Lamb. He shed His blood for us. His blood is on the door of our hearts. His blood protects us. His blood saves us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Cut out a paper door. Color it red. Tape it to your child's bedroom door. Talk about how the blood saved the people. Talk about how the blood of Jesus saves us. Every time you see the door, say, "Jesus saves me."

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for your blood. Thank you for saving me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A door painted with a red stripe.

Day 04: The Shadow of the Bread

The Shadow
"For seven days you are to eat bread made without yeast." - Exodus 12:15

In the Old Testament, the bread was special. It had to be unleavened. It had to be without yeast. Yeast was a symbol of sin. Yeast spreads. Yeast puffs up. The bread was a dot. The bread was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will never go hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty." - John 6:35

Connect the dot. The bread points to Jesus. Jesus is the Bread of Life. He is without yeast. He is without sin. He is pure. He feeds us. He satisfies us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Bake a simple flatbread together. Or buy some pita bread. Talk about how the bread is flat because it has no yeast. Talk about how Jesus is pure like the flatbread. Jesus is the Bread of Life.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Bread of Life. Thank you for feeding me. Thank you for satisfying me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A round loaf of flatbread with a big smile.

Day 05: The Shadow of the Shoes

The Shadow
"This is how you are to eat it: with your cloak tucked into your belt, your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand." - Exodus 12:11

In the Old Testament, the shoes were special. The people had to eat the Passover with their shoes on. They had to be ready to move. They had to be ready to go. The shoes were a dot. The shoes were a shadow.

The Connection
"So you also must be ready, because the Son of Man will come at an hour when you do not expect him." - Matthew 24:44

Connect the dot. The shoes point to Jesus. Jesus calls us to be ready. He is coming back. He wants us to be prepared. He wants us to be watching. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on your shoes. Run around the room. Talk about how the people had to be ready to leave Egypt. Talk about how we need to be ready for Jesus to come back. We need to be ready. We need to be watching.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my guide. Help me to be ready for you. Help me to be watching. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A pair of shoes with a big heart on them.

Day 06: The Shadow of the Staff

The Shadow
"This is how you are to eat it: with your cloak tucked into your belt, your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand." - Exodus 12:11

In the Old Testament, the staff was special. It was a walking stick. It was a tool. It was a guide. The people held the staff. They held it for the journey. The staff was a dot. The staff was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

Connect the dot. The staff points to Jesus. Jesus is the Good Shepherd. He is our guide. He is our help. He leads us. He protects us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Find a stick or a broom. Hold it in your hand. Talk about how a shepherd uses a staff to guide his sheep. Talk about how Jesus is our Good Shepherd. He guides us. He protects us. He leads us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Good Shepherd. Thank you for guiding me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shepherd's staff with a big heart on it.

Day 07: The Shadow of the Bitter Herbs

The Shadow
"Eat the meat roasted over the fire, along with bitter herbs." - Exodus 12:8

In the Old Testament, the bitter herbs were special. They were a reminder. They reminded the people of their slavery. They reminded them of their pain. The bitter herbs were a dot. The bitter herbs were a shadow.

The Connection
"He was pierced for our transgressions, he was crushed for our iniquities." - Isaiah 53:5

Connect the dot. The bitter herbs point to Jesus. Jesus experienced bitter things. He was pierced. He was crushed. He was hurt. He took the pain for us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Taste a lemon or a piece of dark chocolate. Talk about how it tastes bitter. Talk about how Jesus experienced pain for us. Talk about how Jesus understands when we are sad. He is with us in our sad times.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for understanding my pain. Thank you for taking my sadness. Thank you for being with me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A lemon with a sad face turning into a happy face.

Day 08: The Shadow of the Night of Watching

The Shadow
"It is a night of watching for the LORD, to bring them out of Egypt." - Exodus 12:42

In the Old Testament, the night of watching was special. The people were awake. The people were waiting. The people were watching. They were waiting for God to deliver them. The night of watching was a dot. The night of watching was a shadow.

The Connection
"So be on your guard! Remember that for three years I never stopped warning each of you night and day with tears." - Acts 20:31

Connect the dot. The night of watching points to Jesus. Jesus is the one we watch for. He is the one we wait for. He is coming back. We need to be on our guard. We need to be watching. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Turn off the lights. Turn on a flashlight. Play a game of "I Spy" in the dark. Talk about how the people were watching on the night of the Passover. Talk about how we watch for Jesus. He is coming back. We need to be watching.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the one I watch for. Help me to be on my guard. Help me to be watching. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An eye looking for something with a big heart next to it.

Day 09: The Shadow of the Memorial

The Shadow
"This is a day you are to commemorate; for the generations to come you shall celebrate it as a festival to the LORD—a lasting ordinance." - Exodus 12:14

In the Old Testament, the memorial was special. The people were told to remember. They were told to remember what God had done. They were told to remember the day of deliverance. The memorial was a dot. The memorial was a shadow.

The Connection
"Do this in remembrance of me." - 1 Corinthians 11:24

Connect the dot. The memorial points to Jesus. Jesus gave us a memorial. He gave us communion. He said, "Do this in remembrance of me." We remember what Jesus did. We remember His sacrifice. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a special snack together. A cookie. A piece of bread. A cup of juice. Talk about how we remember Jesus when we eat and drink. Talk about how Jesus gave His life for us. We remember Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for remembering me. Help me to remember you. Help me to remember your sacrifice. Help me to remember your love. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A loaf of bread and a cup of juice with a big heart.

Day 10: The Shadow of the Red Sea

The Shadow
"Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD drove the sea back with a strong east wind and turned it into dry land." - Exodus 14:21

In the Old Testament, the Red Sea was special. It was a barrier. It was an obstacle. It was a problem. The people could not cross it. They were trapped. But God parted the sea. He made a way. The Red Sea was a dot. The Red Sea was a shadow.

The Connection
"So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed." - John 8:36

Connect the dot. The Red Sea points to Jesus. Jesus is the one who makes a way. He parts the impossible. He sets us free. He brings us out of slavery. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Fill a bowl with water. Use two stiff pieces of cardboard to part the water. Talk about how God parted the Red Sea. Talk about how Jesus parts the impossible in our lives. He makes a way for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making a way for me. Thank you for parting the impossible. Thank you for setting me free. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two giant walls of water with a dry path in the middle.

Day 11: The Shadow of the Manna

The Shadow
"Then the LORD said to Moses, 'I will rain down bread from heaven for you. The people are to go out each day and gather enough for that day.'" - Exodus 16:4

In the Old Testament, the manna was special. It was bread from heaven. It appeared every morning. The people gathered it. They ate it. They were satisfied. The manna was a dot. The manna was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will never go hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty." - John 6:35

Connect the dot. The manna points to Jesus. Jesus is the true bread from heaven. He is the Bread of Life. He feeds us. He satisfies us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Hide pieces of bread around the room. Let your child find them. Talk about how the people gathered manna every morning. Talk about how Jesus is the Bread of Life. He feeds us. He satisfies us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Bread of Life. Thank you for feeding me. Thank you for satisfying me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Little white flakes falling from the sky with a big smile.

Day 12: The Shadow of the Water from the Rock

The Shadow
"I will stand there before you by the rock at Horeb. Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." - Exodus 17:6

In the Old Testament, the rock was special. It was a source of water. It was a source of life. The people were thirsty. They were complaining. God told Moses to strike the rock. Moses struck the rock. Water came out. The rock was a dot. The rock was a shadow.

The Connection
"They all drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:4

Connect the dot. The rock points to Jesus. Jesus is the spiritual rock. He is the source of living water. He is the one who satisfies our thirsty souls. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Pour water from a pitcher into a cup. Talk about how the rock gave water to the people. Talk about how Jesus gives us living water. He satisfies our thirsty souls.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for satisfying my thirsty soul. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A rock with a big splash of water coming out.

Day 13: The Shadow of the Bronze Serpent

The Shadow
"So Moses made a bronze snake and put it up on a pole. Then when anyone was bitten by a snake and looked at the bronze snake, they lived." - Numbers 21:9

In the Old Testament, the bronze serpent was special. The people were dying. They were bitten by snakes. God told Moses to make a bronze snake. He told him to put it on a pole. Whoever looked at it would live. The bronze serpent was a dot. The bronze serpent was a shadow.

The Connection
"Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes may have eternal life in him." - John 3:14-15

Connect the dot. The bronze serpent points to Jesus. Jesus was lifted up on a cross. He was raised up on a pole. Whoever looks at Him will live. Whoever believes in Him will have eternal life. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Put a stuffed animal on a high shelf. Tell your child to look at it when they feel sad. Talk about how the people looked at the bronze snake and lived. Talk about how we look at Jesus and live.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being lifted up for me. Thank you for the promise that whoever looks at you will live. I am looking at you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A wooden pole with a bronze snake and a big smile.

Day 14: The Shadow of the Cities of Refuge

The Shadow
"Speak to the Israelites and say to them: 'Select some towns to be your cities of refuge, to which a person who has killed someone accidentally may flee.'" - Numbers 35:10-11

In the Old Testament, the cities of refuge were special. They were safe places. They were places of protection. If someone killed a person by accident, they could flee to a city of refuge. They were safe. The cities of refuge were a dot. The cities of refuge were a shadow.

The Connection
"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." - Romans 8:1

Connect the dot. The cities of refuge point to Jesus. Jesus is our city of refuge. He is our safe place. He is our protection. When we run to Him, we are safe. We are not condemned. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a fort with blankets. Crawl inside with your child. Talk about how the cities of refuge were safe places. Talk about how Jesus is our safe place. We can run to Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my city of refuge. Thank you for being my safe place. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fort with a big heart on it.

Day 15: The Shadow of the Sabbath

The Shadow
"Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a sabbath to the LORD your God." - Exodus 20:8-10

In the Old Testament, the Sabbath was special. It was a day of rest. It was a day of ceasing. The people were told to stop working. They were told to rest. The Sabbath was a dot. The Sabbath was a shadow.

The Connection
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Connect the dot. The Sabbath points to Jesus. Jesus is our rest. He is the one who gives us peace. He is the one who gives us rest. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Have a day of rest. Take a nap. Read a book. Go for a walk. Talk about how God wants us to rest. Talk about how Jesus is our rest. We can rest in Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my rest. Thank you for giving me peace. Thank you for giving me rest. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person sleeping peacefully with a big smile.

Day 16: The Shadow of the Jubilee

The Shadow
"Consecrate the fiftieth year and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee for you; each of you is to return to your family property and to your own clan." - Leviticus 25:10

In the Old Testament, the Jubilee was special. It was a year of freedom. It was a year of release. It was a year of restoration. Every fifty years, the Israelites were to proclaim liberty. Slaves were set free. Debts were cancelled. The Jubilee was a dot. The Jubilee was a shadow.

The Connection
"The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to set the oppressed free, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor." - Luke 4:18-19

Connect the dot. The Jubilee points to Jesus. Jesus is our Jubilee. He is our freedom. He is our release. He is our restoration. He proclaims good news to the poor. He sets the oppressed free. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Ring a bell. Shout "Freedom!" Talk about how the Jubilee was a year of freedom. Talk about how Jesus sets us free. We can be free because of Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Jubilee. Thank you for proclaiming freedom to me. Thank you for releasing me from bondage. Thank you for restoring me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A bell with a big smile.

Day 17: The Shadow of the Day of Atonement

The Shadow
"This is to be a lasting ordinance for you: On the tenth day of the seventh month you must deny yourselves and not do any work—whether native-born or a foreigner residing among you—because on this day atonement will be made for you, to cleanse you." - Leviticus 16:29-30

In the Old Testament, the Day of Atonement was special. It was the holiest day of the year. It was a day of fasting. It was a day of sacrifice. It was a day of cleansing. The Day of Atonement was a dot. The Day of Atonement was a shadow.

The Connection
"He did not enter by means of the blood of goats and calves; but he entered the Most Holy Place once for all by his own blood, thus obtaining eternal redemption." - Hebrews 9:12

Connect the dot. The Day of Atonement points to Jesus. Jesus is our Day of Atonement. He is our High Priest. He is our sacrifice. He entered the Most Holy Place once for all. He obtained eternal redemption. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Talk about a time you needed to be cleansed. Talk about how Jesus cleanses us. He made atonement for us. Once. For all. We can be clean because of Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Day of Atonement. Thank you for entering the Most Holy Place. Thank you for obtaining eternal redemption. Thank you for cleansing me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a cross and a smile inside it.

Day 18: The Shadow of the Scapegoat

The Shadow
"He is to lay both hands on the head of the live goat and confess over it all the wickedness and rebellion of the Israelites—all their sins—and put them on the goat's head. He shall send the goat away into the wilderness." - Leviticus 16:21

In the Old Testament, the scapegoat was special. The high priest laid his hands on it. He confessed the sins of the people. He put the sins on the goat's head. He sent the goat away. The scapegoat was a dot. The scapegoat was a shadow.

The Connection
"We all, like sheep, have gone astray, each of us has turned to our own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all." - Isaiah 53:6

Connect the dot. The scapegoat points to Jesus. Jesus is our scapegoat. The sins of the world were laid on Him. He carried them away. He took them to the cross. He took them to the grave. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Write a mistake on a piece of paper. Tie it to a balloon. Let the balloon go. Talk about how the scapegoat carried the sins away. Talk about how Jesus carries our sins away. They are gone.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for carrying my sins away. Thank you for taking them to the cross. Thank you for removing them. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A goat with a big heart on it.

Day 19: The Shadow of the Temple

The Shadow
"I have indeed built a magnificent temple for you, a place for you to dwell forever." - 1 Kings 8:13

In the Old Testament, the temple was special. It was the dwelling place of God. It was where God met with His people. It was where the sacrifices were made. The temple was a dot. The temple was a shadow.

The Connection

"Jesus answered them, 'Destroy this temple, and I will raise it again in three days.' But the temple he had spoken of was his body." - John 2:19-21

Connect the dot. The temple points to Jesus. Jesus is the temple. He is the dwelling place of God. He is the meeting place. He is the sacrifice. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a temple out of blocks. Talk about how the temple was the dwelling place of God. Talk about how Jesus is the temple. He is the dwelling place of God. We meet God in Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the temple. Thank you for being the dwelling place of God. Thank you for being the meeting place. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful building with a big heart on it.

Day 20: The Shadow of the High Priest

The Shadow
"The LORD said to Moses: 'Tell your brother Aaron that he is not to come whenever he chooses into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain in front of the atonement cover on the ark, or else he will die.'" - Leviticus 16:2

In the Old Testament, the high priest was special. He was the mediator. He was the go-between. He represented the people before God. He offered sacrifices. He made atonement. The high priest was a dot. The high priest was a shadow.

The Connection
"Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has ascended into heaven, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess." - Hebrews 4:14

Connect the dot. The high priest points to Jesus. Jesus is our High Priest. He is our mediator. He is our go-between. He represents us before God. He intercedes for us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Talk about how the high priest had to be careful. Talk about how Jesus is our High Priest. He entered the Most Holy Place for us. He made a way. We can come to God because of Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my High Priest. Thank you for representing me before God. Thank you for interceding for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A high priest with a big heart on his chest.

Day 21: The Shadow of the Prophet

The Shadow
"The LORD your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among you, from your fellow Israelites. You must listen to him." - Deuteronomy 18:15

In the Old Testament, the prophet was special. He was the messenger. He was the voice of God. He spoke God's words. He told the people what God wanted them to know. The prophet was a dot. The prophet was a shadow.

The Connection
"For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own people; you must listen to everything he tells you.'" - Acts 3:22

Connect the dot. The prophet points to Jesus. Jesus is the ultimate prophet. He is the voice of God. He speaks God's words. He tells us what God wants us to know. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Play a game of "telephone." Whisper a message to your child. Let them whisper it to someone else. Talk about how the prophets spoke God's words. Talk about how Jesus is the ultimate prophet. He speaks God's words to us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the ultimate prophet. Thank you for speaking God's words. Thank you for telling me what God wants me to know. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person speaking with a big heart next to them.

Day 22: The Shadow of the King

The Shadow
"The LORD your God will raise up for you a king from among your fellow Israelites. You must listen to him." - Deuteronomy 17:15

In the Old Testament, the king was special. He was the ruler. He was the leader. He was the one who led the people. He was the one who protected them. The king was a dot. The king was a shadow.

The Connection

"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

Connect the dot. The king points to Jesus. Jesus is the King of Kings. He is the ruler. He is the leader. He is the one who leads us. He is the one who protects us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Decorate it with stickers. Put it on your child's head. Talk about how the king led the people. Talk about how Jesus is the King of Kings. He leads us. He protects us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the King of Kings. Thank you for leading me. Thank you for protecting me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A golden crown with a big heart on it.

Day 23: The Shadow of the Shepherd

The Shadow
"The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing. He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters." - Psalm 23:1-2

In the Old Testament, the shepherd was special. He was the guide. He was the protector. He was the provider. He led the sheep. He protected the sheep. He provided for the sheep. The shepherd was a dot. The shepherd was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." - John 10:11

Connect the dot. The shepherd points to Jesus. Jesus is the Good Shepherd. He is our guide. He is our protector. He is our provider. He leads us. He protects us. He provides for us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a shepherd with his sheep. Talk about how the shepherd leads and protects his sheep. Talk about how Jesus is our Good Shepherd. He leads us. He protects us. He provides for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Good Shepherd. Thank you for leading me. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for providing for me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A shepherd with his sheep and a big heart.

Day 24: The Shadow of the Rock

The Shadow
"He is the Rock, his works are perfect, and all his ways are just. A faithful God who does no wrong, upright and just is he." - Deuteronomy 32:4

In the Old Testament, the rock was special. It was a symbol of strength. It was a symbol of stability. It was a symbol of safety. The rock was a dot. The rock was a shadow.

The Connection
"They all drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ." - 1 Corinthians 10:4

Connect the dot. The rock points to Jesus. Jesus is our Rock. He is our strength. He is our stability. He is our safety. He is the one we can build our lives on. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Find a big rock. Touch it. Talk about how the rock is strong and stable. Talk about how Jesus is our Rock. He is strong. He is stable. We can build our lives on Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my Rock. Thank you for being my strength. Thank you for being my stability. Thank you for being my safety. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big rock with a cross and a big smile.

Day 25: The Shadow of the Lamp

The Shadow
"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." - Psalm 119:105

In the Old Testament, the lamp was special. It was a source of light. It was a source of guidance. It helped the people see where they were going. The lamp was a dot. The lamp was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Connect the dot. The lamp points to Jesus. Jesus is the Light of the World. He is the source of light. He is the source of guidance. He helps us see where we are going. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Turn off the lights. Light a candle. Talk about how the lamp helped the people see. Talk about how Jesus is the Light of the World. He helps us see. He guides us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the Light of the World. Thank you for guiding me. Thank you for helping me see. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A lamp with a big smile.

Day 26: The Shadow of the Bread of the Presence

The Shadow
"Put the bread of the Presence on this table to be before me at all times." - Exodus 25:30

In the Old Testament, the bread of the Presence was special. It was a symbol of the presence of God. It was a symbol of the provision of God. It was a symbol of the bread of life. The bread of the Presence was a dot. The bread of the Presence was a shadow.

The Connection
"I am the living bread that came down from heaven. Whoever eats this bread will live forever. This bread is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world." - John 6:51

Connect the dot. The bread of the Presence points to Jesus. Jesus is the living bread. He is the bread of life. He is the bread that came down from heaven. He is the one who feeds us. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Set a special table. Put bread on it. Talk about how the bread of the Presence was on the table. Talk about how Jesus is the living bread. We can feed on Him. We can be satisfied.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living bread. Thank you for feeding me. Thank you for satisfying me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A table with a loaf of bread and a big smile.

Day 27: The Shadow of the Incense

The Shadow
"Aaron must burn fragrant incense on the altar every morning when he tends the lamps." - Exodus 30:7

In the Old Testament, the incense was special. It was a sweet smell. It was burned every morning. It was burned on the altar. It filled the tabernacle. It rose to heaven. It was a picture of prayer. The incense was a dot. The incense was a shadow.

The Connection
"The smoke of the incense, together with the prayers of God's people, went up before God from the angel's hand." - Revelation 8:4

Connect the dot. The incense points to Jesus. Jesus is the one who prays for us. He is the one who intercedes for us. His prayers rise to heaven. Our prayers rise to heaven because of Him. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Smell a sweet candle or flower. Talk about how the incense was a sweet smell. Talk about how our prayers rise to heaven. Jesus is the one who prays for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for praying for me. Thank you for interceding for me. Thank you for making my prayers rise to heaven. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A cloud of incense with a big heart.

Day 28: The Shadow of the Mercy Seat

The Shadow
"Make an atonement cover of pure gold—two and a half cubits long and a cubit and a half wide." - Exodus 25:17

In the Old Testament, the mercy seat was special. It was the lid of the ark. It was made of pure gold. It was the place where the blood was sprinkled. It was the place of atonement. It was the place of mercy. The mercy seat was a dot. The mercy seat was a shadow.

The Connection
"God presented Christ as a sacrifice of atonement, through the shedding of his blood—to be received by faith." - Romans 3:25

Connect the dot. The mercy seat points to Jesus. Jesus is the mercy seat. He is the atonement. He is the place of mercy. His blood was sprinkled. His sacrifice was made. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a golden box with a lid. Talk about how the mercy seat was the lid of the ark. Talk about how Jesus is the mercy seat. He is the place of mercy. We can come to Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the mercy seat. Thank you for being the atonement. Thank you for being the place of mercy. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A golden box with a big smile on the lid.

Day 29: The Shadow of the Veil

The Shadow
"Hang the curtain from the clasps and place the ark of the covenant law behind the curtain. The curtain will separate the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place." - Exodus 26:33

In the Old Testament, the veil was special. It was a thick curtain. It separated the people from the Most Holy Place. It separated them from the presence of God. The veil was a dot. The veil was a shadow.

The Connection
"At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:51

Connect the dot. The veil points to Jesus. The veil separated the people from God. When Jesus died, the veil was torn in two. The barrier was removed. The separation was ended. The dot connects to Jesus. The picture is Jesus.

Family Activity
Take a piece of paper. Talk about how it separates you from something. Then rip the paper in half. Talk about how the veil was torn when Jesus died. We can come to God now. We have access.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for removing the barrier. Thank you for tearing the veil. Thank you for giving me access to God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A torn curtain with a big heart.

Day 30: The Real Picture

The Shadow

"These are a shadow of the things that were to come; the reality, however, is found in Christ." - Colossians 2:17

All the dots were shadows. They were clues. They were pointing to something. They were pointing to someone. They were pointing to Jesus. When we connect the dots, we see the picture. The picture is Jesus.

The Connection
"For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed." - 1 Corinthians 5:7

Jesus is the real picture. He is the fulfillment of every shadow. He is the meaning behind every dot. He is the treasure at the end of the hunt. When we connect the dots, we find Jesus. He was there all along.

Family Activity
Draw a picture using dots. Connect the dots to reveal the picture. Talk about how the Old Testament is like a connect the dots page. When we connect the dots, we see Jesus. We found Him. We love Him. We thank Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the real picture. Thank you for being the fulfillment of every shadow. Thank you for being the treasure. Help me to live in the reality. Help me to live in you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big picture of Jesus with a big smile.

END MATTER

The "Prophecy Detective" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Shadow Game adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Divine Blueprint Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was the coolest dot you connected this week?
Card 2: What is your favorite shadow from the Old Testament?
Card 3: Why do you think God gave so many shadows?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is the real picture?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?

Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days connecting the dots from the Old Testament to Jesus. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Divine Blueprint for Kids

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Divine Blueprint for Kids takes you on a journey through 30 secret clues that point to Jesus. It is full of fun activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a page of connect the dots. The dots are forming a picture of a cross. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title THE SHADOW GAME is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word GAME is in bright red with a game controller replacing the letter G. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.